InnerCircle — Design Specifications

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1. Brand Identity & Concept

InnerCircle is a private journaling and emotional wellness app that uses AI to summarize mood patterns and allows users to selectively share insights with their trusted circle. The concept is warm, intimate, and emotionally safe — and the design should reflect that at every touchpoint. The foundation is already there and has real heart; with some refinement and polish, this app can feel as trustworthy and professional as the mission behind it deserves.

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2. Color Palette

Current Colors Observed

Role	Color	Notes
Primary / Brand	Purple (~`#7B2FBE` / vivid violet)	Used on buttons, FAB, heading accents, AI cards
Primary Light	Soft lavender/lilac (~`#C9A9E8`)	Mood dots, secondary accents
Background	Off-white / warm blush (~`#F7F3F0`)	Global page background
Card Background	White (`#FFFFFF`) with soft rounded shadow	Entry cards, mood section cards
Mood Tag – Calm	Soft pastel pink (~`#F4C6CE`)	Mood badge pill
AI Insight Card	Purple-to-pink gradient (`#7B2FBE` → `#E472A0`)	AI Insight card on EntryDetail
Weekly Reflection Card	Solid deep purple (`#6B21A8`)	Insights page card
Feature Icon – Journaling	Purple (~`#7B2FBE`)	Onboarding icon

Feature Icon – AI Insights	Soft teal/green (~`#7ECFBA`)	Onboarding icon
Feature Icon – Trusted Sharing	Soft pink (~`#F4A4B2`)	Onboarding icon
Text – Primary	Dark charcoal (~`#1A1A2E`)	Body copy
Text – Secondary	Medium gray (~`#8A8A99`)	Timestamps, subtitles
Text – Accent	Purple (~`#7B2FBE`)	Links, subtitle accents, dates
Destructive / Delete	Coral pink/red (~`#F08080`)	Swipe-to-delete background
Permission Tag – Mood	Pastel green (~`#B2E8C4`)	Circle permission chips
Permission Tag – Summaries	Pastel pink (~`#F4C6CE`)	Circle permission chips

Recommendations

The palette has a genuinely beautiful foundation — the warm blush background paired with the regal purple is comforting and unique. However, the color system currently lacks clear hierarchy rules, and the purple used in interactive buttons is very saturated and can feel jarring against the soft, gentle aesthetic of the rest of the screen. Consider defining a consistent shade as the single "brand purple" and using it sparingly. Introduce a more muted, accessible version of the purple (e.g., a soft violet around #8B5CF6 or #9B6DDF) for secondary elements to reduce visual tension and lend the app a calmer, more elevated feel.

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3. Typography

Current Typography Observed

Element	Style	Notes
App Name "InnerCircle" (Login)	Serif, light weight, large (~28–32pt)	Elegant; feels slightly decorative
Page Headings ("Hello, Sarah", "Your Insights", "Trusted Circle")	Serif, regular, large (~26–30pt)	Consistent serif usage; warm but slightly inconsistent sizing

Sub-headings ("TODAY'S MOOD", "YOUR ENTRY")	Sans-serif, uppercase, small (~10–11pt), tracked	Used as section labels
Body text	Serif, light, medium (~14–16pt)	Used for entry previews and descriptions
Accent/Prompt text ("What's on your mind?", "Patterns in your emotional journey")	Italic serif or purple accent, medium (~14–16pt)	Adds warmth but can feel informal
Button labels ("Sign In", "Save Entry")	Sans-serif, medium weight, ~16pt	White on purple
Timestamps / metadata	Sans-serif, light, small (~12pt)	Secondary gray
Caption text / hint text	Sans-serif, light italic, ~12pt	Form hints, sharing note

Recommendations

The serif typeface choice is lovely and well-suited to the intimate, journal-like nature of the app. However, the current typography mix feels slightly unplanned — the serif is used inconsistently across headings and body copy, and some labels (like the Notifications page title) shift to a bolder sans-serif unexpectedly. Establish a clear two-font system: one elegant serif (e.g., a Google Font like Playfair Display or Cormorant Garamond) for headings and display text, and one clean sans-serif (e.g., Inter or DM Sans) for all UI labels, body text, and form elements. Define a consistent type scale and stick to it across all screens. This alone will dramatically elevate the perceived professionalism of the app.

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4. Spacing & Layout

Current Layout Observations

- **Screen width:** Mobile, approximately 390px (iPhone standard)
- **Page margin/padding:** Approximately 16–20px horizontal padding on most screens
- **Card padding:** Approximately 16px internal padding on entry/mood cards
- **Section gap:** Variable — some sections feel tightly packed, others have generous whitespace
- **Border radius:** Cards use a generous rounded radius (~16px); buttons use fully rounded pill shape (~24px radius)
- **Card border:** Subtle light gray border on most cards, no strong shadow

- **FAB (Floating Action Button):** 56px diameter, positioned bottom-right above tab bar

Recommendations

The overall whitespace philosophy is on the right track and the generous card rounding is warm and approachable. The main issue is inconsistency — spacing between sections varies noticeably from page to page, which makes the app feel unfinished. Define a spacing scale (e.g., 4/8/16/24/32/48px) and apply it consistently across all screens. The section header labels (like "TODAY'S MOOD", "YOUR CONNECTIONS") should all sit at a uniform distance from the preceding element. Cards should all share the same padding, shadow, and border radius definition.

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5. Components & UI Patterns

5.1 Buttons

Type	Style	Usage
Primary CTA	Full-width pill, solid vivid purple, white text	Sign In, Save Entry, Continue, Join InnerCircle, Log Out
Text Link	Underlined purple text	Forgot Password, Sign In (from SignUp)
Navigation Row	White card with label, description, and chevron ">"	Profile menu items (Edit Profile, Notifications, Help & FAQ, etc.)

Recommendation: The full-width purple CTA button works well and is recognizable. However, the "Log Out" action using the same style as "Sign In" or "Save Entry" creates a false visual equivalence between a destructive action and a positive one. Log Out should use a lighter, outlined, or subtly different style to signal a different intent. Also, the dashes around the Notifications subtitle ("-Choose what you want to be notified about-") feel informal and out of place — this formatting should be replaced with a clean, minimal subtitle.

5.2 Input Fields

- Rectangular, white fill, light gray border, rounded corners (~8px)
- Label sits above the field in uppercase small caps
- Placeholder text is gray/light italic
- Password hint text appears below the field in small gray type

Recommendation: The form fields feel functional but minimal to the point of feeling skeletal. Consider adding a subtle focus state (e.g., a soft purple border glow on active input) and ensure

consistent padding inside each field. A slightly warmer field background (e.g., a very light blush rather than pure white) would tie the forms into the overall page warmth.

5.3 Mood Selector / Chips

- Horizontal scrollable row of mood items on Home and NewEntry
- Each mood item has a purple circle dot indicator above the label
- Mood badges on entries use a soft pink pill shape

Recommendation: The mood selector is a central feature of the app and deserves more visual attention. The current implementation with placeholder text ("Current item's mood") makes it very clear this is not polished yet. Each mood should have a distinct color-coded dot, a legible label, and a clear selected/unselected state. Consider adding a subtle ripple or scale animation on selection to make the interaction feel satisfying.

5.4 AI Insight Card

- Gradient background (purple to pink)
- Star/sparkle icon in top left
- Italic serif body text in white
- Appears on EntryDetail and Insights pages

Recommendation: This is one of the most visually compelling elements in the app and does a good job of making the AI feel warm rather than clinical. The gradient direction and tone work well. Make sure the text contrast on the gradient always meets accessibility standards (WCAG AA minimum 4.5:1). Consider standardizing the card header label style ("AI INSIGHT", "WEEKLY REFLECTION") to always use the same capitalization, spacing, and icon treatment.

5.5 Entry Cards

- White card with rounded corners and subtle border
- Date and time in top-left (date bold, time in gray)
- Mood badge pill in top-right (pastel fill, matching mood color)
- Entry preview text in serif, muted gray
- "Shared with circle" indicator (eye icon + small text) at bottom
- Swipe-to-delete reveals a coral/pink trash icon panel

Recommendation: The entry card design is clean and clear. The serif text for the preview gives it a journal-like warmth. The "Shared with circle" indicator is appropriately understated. The one issue is the pastel pink mood badge — the "Calm" label sits inside it in a slightly too-small font, making it feel like an afterthought. Size the mood badge text up slightly and ensure the pill has enough horizontal padding to breathe.

5.6 Tab Bar (Bottom Navigation)

- 4 icons: Journal/Entries (book icon), Insights (chart icon), Circles (people icon), Profile (person icon)
- Gray icons, no labels currently visible, light background

Recommendation: The tab bar currently has no text labels beneath the icons, which is a notable accessibility and usability concern — icons alone are not always intuitive, especially for a newer user. Add short text labels below each icon (e.g., "Journal", "Insights", "Circles", "Profile"). The active/selected state should use the brand purple to clearly communicate which tab is current. This is a straightforward change that will immediately make the navigation feel more polished and trustworthy.

5.7 Floating Action Button (FAB)

- Solid vivid purple circle, ~56px diameter
- White "+" icon centered
- Positioned bottom-right, above the tab bar
- Used to create a new journal entry

Recommendation: The FAB is well-placed and clear in its intent. Ensure there is consistent bottom padding above the tab bar so it never overlaps the tab icons. Consider adding a subtle drop shadow to lift it off the page and reinforce its primary action status.

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6. Screen-by-Screen Summary

6.1 Login

- Logo (purple heart circle) + app name + tagline
- Email + Password fields
- "Sign In" CTA
- "Forgot Password" text link
- **Issue:** No "Create Account" or "Sign Up" link visible from Login — users who don't have an account may feel stuck.

6.2 Sign Up

- "Create Account" heading + "Begin your journaling journey" subtitle
- Name, Email, Create Password fields with password hint
- "Sign In" link (for existing users)
- Invite code section with "Join InnerCircle" CTA
- Terms/Privacy fine print
- **Issue:** The dual sign-up paths (standard form + invite code) create visual confusion. Consider presenting these more clearly as two distinct options with a clear visual separator and context.

6.3 Onboarding (Slides 1–4)

- Brand logo + "Welcome to InnerCircle"
- Descriptive body copy
- Feature list with icon+label+description rows (Private Journaling, AI Insights, Trusted Sharing)
- Dots pagination indicator
- "Continue" CTA
- **Issue:** The three feature icons use three different colors (purple, teal, pink) which is inconsistent with the rest of the color system. Align these to the established palette.

6.4 Home

- Personalized greeting ("Hello, Sarah")
- "How are you feeling today?" subtitle
- "TODAY'S MOOD" horizontal scrolling mood selector card
- "Recent Entries" section with list of entry cards
- FAB for new entry
- Tab bar navigation
- **Issue:** The mood selector shows placeholder data instead of real mood labels — this needs to be resolved before launch as it's the first thing users see.

6.5 New Entry

- "New Entry" header with back arrow
- Date/time display in purple
- "What's on your mind?" italic purple prompt
- Large text area for journaling
- "HOW ARE YOU FEELING?" mood selection list
- "Share with your circle" toggle with description
- "Save Entry" CTA
- **Issue:** The mood list items show as generic rows without emotion labels or visual differentiation. These need proper mood names and ideally colored indicators.

6.6 Entry Detail

- "Entry Detail" header with back arrow and edit pencil icon
- Date/time
- Mood badge (e.g., "Feeling Calm" in mint green)
- AI Insight gradient card
- "YOUR ENTRY" plain text section
- "SHARING" section showing who the AI insight was shared with
- **Issue:** The gradient AI card partially obscures itself in the editor preview — verify it renders cleanly in the live app.

6.7 All Entries

- List of entry cards (date, time, mood badge, preview, sharing indicator)
- Swipe-to-delete gesture
- **Issue:** No search, filter, or sort controls. As the journal grows, users will need a way to find past entries. Consider a filter by mood or date range.

6.8 Insights

- "Your Insights" heading + "Patterns in your emotional journey" subtitle
- Week/Month/Year time period toggle (pill-shaped selector)
- Journaling Streak card (Current Streak, Longest Streak, Last Entry)
- Weekly Reflection card (solid purple, AI-generated text)
- **Issue:** The time period toggle does not have a clear selected/active state in the current design — ensure the active option has a distinct fill or indicator.

6.9 Trusted Circle / My Circles

- "Trusted Circle" / "My Circles" heading with subtitle
- "Invite someone / Send a private invitation" action card
- "YOUR CONNECTIONS" list with connection cards (avatar, name, permission tags: Mood / Summaries, gear icon)
- **Issue:** The permission tags (Mood, Summaries) are visually clear, but there is no in-context explanation of what these permissions mean. A first-time user won't know the difference. Consider a subtle info icon or a brief onboarding tooltip.

6.10 Profile

- Avatar (purple circle with default user icon)
- Display name + email
- Stats row (Entries | In Circle | Streak Days)
- Menu items: Edit Profile, Notifications, Connection Settings
- Support section: Help & FAQ, Send Feedback
- "Log Out" CTA
- **Issue:** The stats row shows dynamic data fields but lacks numeric context — e.g., "42 Entries | 3 In Circle | 7 Days." Make sure labels and values are clearly hierarchically distinct.

6.11 Notifications

- "Notifications" heading in bold purple
- Notification types with checkboxes: Journaling Reminder, Daily Inspiration, Weekly Progress Summary, Circle Activity

- **Issue:** The dashes surrounding the subtitle ("-Choose what you want to be notified about-") are informal and should be removed. The heading font on this page also appears heavier/different from other screens — align to the global heading style.

6.12 Forgot Password / Reset Password

- Standard utility screens
- **Recommendation:** Ensure the tone of the helper text on these screens is warm and reassuring (e.g., "No worries — happens to everyone! Enter your email below and we'll send you a reset link.") rather than clinical.

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7. Navigation Architecture

Auth Flow: Login → (Forgot Password / Reset Password) | Sign Up → Onboarding (Slides 1–4) → Home

Main App (Tab Bar):
├── Journal / Entries (Home + All Entries)
├── Insights
├── Circles (My Circles / Trusted Circle + Create Circle + Invite Person)
└── Profile (Edit Profile, Notifications, Connection Settings, Help & FAQ, Send Feedback)

Overlay / Modal: FAB → New Entry → Entry Detail

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8. Overall Design Health Assessment & Recommendations

You've built something with genuine warmth and purpose, and that's actually the hardest part — the soul of the app is already there. What's needed now is a refinement pass to bring the visual execution up to match the quality of the concept. Here's a prioritized list of improvements:

High Priority (Polish & Trust) The single most impactful change you can make is replacing all placeholder content (the "Current item's mood," "Current item's text" labels, and the database field names that appear in the UI editor) with real, finalized copy before showing the app to anyone. These placeholders, even in a preview, immediately signal "unfinished" to anyone looking. Alongside this, adding text labels to the tab bar icons will make the app feel immediately more complete and professional.

Medium Priority (Consistency) Establish a design system — even a simple one — that defines your exact purple hex value, your two fonts and their size scale, your standard card padding and border radius, and your spacing tokens. Right now these vary subtly from screen to

screen, and that inconsistency creates a vague sense that something is "off" even if the viewer can't articulate exactly what. Consistency is the most powerful signal of a professional, trustworthy product.

Medium Priority (Tone & Warmth) The copy is already thoughtful and caring in places ("A safe space for your thoughts — shared with those who care"), but some screens fall into clinical or technical phrasing. Do a copy audit across all screens and ensure every instruction, label, empty state, and error message speaks with the same warm, encouraging, non-judgmental voice. The app deals with people's emotions — the language should always make them feel safe and supported.

Lower Priority (Experience Enhancement) Consider adding empty states for screens like All Entries and Trusted Circle (e.g., an illustration + encouraging prompt for when a user has no entries yet), adding visible focus states to all form inputs for accessibility, and reviewing the color contrast on lighter text/badge elements to ensure WCAG compliance.